

ANNOUNCEMENTS

FUNERAL ANNOUNCEMENTS

1. The One-Week Observation of **Madam Agnes Baah** will be held on **Saturday 21st September, 2024** at the Church premises.

2. The funeral Mass for **Mrs. Mary Ekua Atta Mensah** is on **Saturday, 12th October 2024**, at **St. Francis Cathedral, Cape Coast**, with a **Thanksgiving Mass** on Sunday, 13th October at 9:00 am.

ADMISSION 2024/2025 ACADEMIC YEAR

Admission of children between 2 and 3 years into Nursery 1 is in progress. Contact the Parish Secretary for registration.

PAYMENT OF CHURCH DUES

Parishioners are encouraged to pay their Annual Church Dues at the Secretary's Desk.

- ❖ **Children – Ghs 6.00**
- ❖ **Students – Ghs 12.00**

LAST WEEK'S COLLECTION

FIRST COLLECTION: GHC 2,268.20
SECOND COLLECTION: GHC 1,328.10
SUNDAY SCHOOL: GHC 121.59

ST. STEPHEN PARISH MONTHLY TRIDUUM (SEPTEMBER, 2024)

➤ **Holy Hour (Eucharistic Adoration)**

Thursday 5th September, 2024

Time: 6:30 pm

GROTTO MASS

There will be Grotto Mass on Saturday 7th September, 2024 at St. John the Baptist Catholic Church, Odorkor at 2:30 pm. Parishioners are entreated to attend.

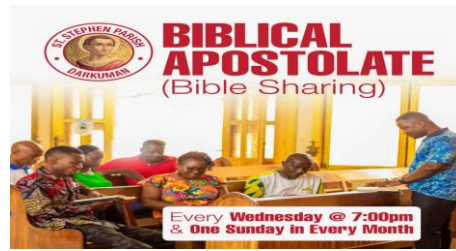
MASS WEDDING REGISTRATION

Candidates who have registered for the upcoming Mass Wedding will have a meeting with the Counsellors after Mass on Sunday 1st September, 2024 in front of the Parish Office.

CHURCH CLEANING

The cleaning of the Church will be the responsibility of **St. John Cadet and Jnr.**

Aux. for next Saturday.



St. Stephen Catholic Church

Slogan: "Lor Lor Sonj; Odo Nkoaaa!!!!!"

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1ST SEPTEMBER, 2024 TWENTY-SECOND SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME

Parish Weekly Bulletin

No. 12

Vol 24

1st - 8th September 2024

PARISH INFORMATION

PARISH PRIEST – Rev. Fr. Robert Billy Gbettey.

Parish MOMO Number: **055-190-1335**,

MOMO Merchant ID: **471333**

Account Name: **St. Stephen Catholic Church.**

WEEKDAY MASSES

- **Morning Mass – Tuesdays, Wednesdays:** 6:00am
- **Thursdays and Saturdays:** 6:30am
- **Evening Mass – Fridays (Youth Mass):** 7:00pm
- **Confessions – Every Saturday at 5.00pm**
- **Infant Baptism – 1st Saturday of every month**

SUNDAY MASS SCHEDULE

1st Mass – Sunday Morning: Reporting Time 6:30am. **Mass Begins: 7:00am.**

2nd Mass – Sunday Morning: Reporting Time 8:30am. **Mass Begins: 9:00am.**

TODAY'S READINGS

First Reading: Deuteronomy 4:1-2,66-8

Responsorial Psalm: Psalms (".")

Second Reading: James 1:17-18. 2-22.27

Gospel: Mark 7:1-8.8.14-15.21-23

TODAY'S PROGRAMME

There will be One (1) Mass

- Time: 7:30 a.m.

Bidding Prayers and offertory gifts:

- Marshallans

Second Offering: There will be Kofi and Ama Thanksgiving Offering

8TH SEPTEMBER, 2024

TWENTY-THIRD SUNDAY IN

ORDINARY TIME - YEAR B

There will be Two (2) Masses

- First Mass: 7:00 a.m.
- Second Mass: 9:00 a.m.

Bidding Prayers and offertory gifts:

- First Mass: St. John Cadet and Jnr. Aux.
- Second Mass: C. C. R.

Second Offering: In aid of Parish Activities

**REFLECTION ON TWENTY - SECOND
SUNDAY IN ORDINARY TIME (YEAR B)**

Today, the scriptures focus our attention on two basic attitudes that are to characterize us as a community. The first is the law of God (the word of God), is meant to change our hearts and then our actions. The second is that God's word is meant to be lived not just heard.

Jesus reminded the Pharisees in today's gospel that good and evil come from what is in our hearts. That is the only way that our actions can truly be holy actions. When we allow ourselves to be open and receive the immerse love that God has for us and understand how passionately God desire us to live in his love, then our hearts will profoundly change. As a result we are better able to hear God's word for what is – a word spoken to us because he loves us and desires us to be with him.

Today's scriptures tell us to be more careful to our God who love us and then look inside ourselves, at our heart. I am I hearing God's word as a word of love for me? Am I letting God's word of love change my heart? Do I spend enough time with God so that I am renewed by His love? God's love is what makes us the Body of Christ, a community of faith. May we be wise in choosing to live by God's love.

READINGS FOR THE WEEK

Mon. 2nd September, 2024

1 Corinthians 2:1-5
Psalm 119:97. 98. 99. 100 .101. 102
Luke 4:16-30

Tues. 3rd September, 2024

1 Corinthians 2:10-16
Psalm 145:8-9. 10-11. 12-13. 14
Luke 4:31-37

Wed. 4th September, 2024

1 Corinthians 3:1-9
Psalm 33:12-13. 14-15. 20-21
Luke 4:38-44

Thurs. 5th September, 2024

1 Corinthians 3:18-23
Psalm 24:1-2. 3-4. 5-6
Luke 5:1-11

Fri. 6th September, 2024

1 Corinthians 4:1-5
Psalm 37:3-4. 5-6. 27-28. 39-40
Luke 5:33-29

Sat. 7th September, 2024

1 Corinthians 4:6-15
Psalm 145:17-18. 19-20. 21
Luke 6:1-5

Sun. 8th September, 2024

Isaiah 35:4-7
Psalm 146:6-7. 8-10
James 2:1-5
Mark 7:31-37

**FAITH SHARING FOR SOCIETAL AND
DEVOTIONAL GROUPS**

Jesus' words are strong about getting caught up in what one does on the outside. Religious cannot be all externals. Jesus takes the offensive here. He adapts a quote from Isaiah about paying lip service to God with no heart. He warns them about insisting that human rules are God's law.

Deteronomy speaks of God's law as a way to show gratitude for God's great love; they are simply a way to respond with love to God's goodness. The Pharisees took God's law seriously and followed it with devotion. But a few Pharisees forgot the heart of religion – God's relationship with - people – and got trapped in mere regulations. This passage can speak to our own lives in the Church

**REFLECTION FROM BIBLICAL
APOSTOLATE (BIBLE SHARING).**

NEHEMIAH 5

As leaders, we can balance our own needs of the members of our church community by embracing the mystery that God created man in His own image and likeness. That is, we are to see each other in God in everyone. Our responsibility is to exercise acts of patience,

Love, fear of God, prayer, compassion and selflessness to ensure justice and fairness.

To truly repent and restore what is owed to others, we must accept the truth, be humble, prayerful, obedient, receptive with an open heart, resist doing evil, put into practice the word of God, and be agents of peace. Societal leaders must take a step of faith to address church issues at meetings and be courageous to stand for the truth towards the spiritual growth and welfare of the church.

Nehemiah was a man who feared God. The fear of God means to be generous, kind, forgiving, loving, obedient, truthful and peacemaker.

NEHEMIAH 2

1. As Catholics, we must seek God's guidance in all our decisions and actions by putting God first and taking advantage of the Blessed Sacrament to seek His face. God is an answering God, and His answers are always in the right direction.